

[00:07] **Interviewer:** So, I'm going to, um, start po with our interview. So, ako po si [Name], I'm a researcher para sa isang project na ManyQuali. Before we start po pala, would you be more comfortable in Filipino or in English? Or kahit ano po?

[00:24] **Speaker:** Kahit ano, I'm fine.

[00:26] **Interviewer:** Okay po. So, this research po is to gauge the quality of relationships, 'no. So, ginagawa po namin 'tong research na to in five countries—in US, Brazil, France, Netherlands, and here in the Philippines. So, 'yong interview po natin can last up to 30 minutes to 1 hour depending on what you share po. So, if you need a break po, don't hesitate to ask for a break. Ayan. So, we're going to record this interview but we're not going to share it with other people. This is only for transcription po. So, do you have any questions po, before we start?

[1:05] **Speaker:** Yeah, none so far.

[1:07] **Interviewer:** Okay po. So, may we ask po kung ilang taon na po kayo?

[1:12] **Speaker:** I'm [46-50] years old.

[1:15] **Interviewer:** Okay po. May we know po gaano na po kayo katagal ni-ni [Partner's Name]?

[1:23] **Speaker:** Married?

[1:25] **Interviewer:** Married po and boyfriend-girlfriend.

[1:28] **Speaker:** I think we're married for [16-20] years.

[1:33] **Interviewer:** [16-20] years. Opo. But how long have you known each other po?

[1:41] **Speaker:** For a while. [Partner's Name].

[1:50] **Speaker:** For a while lang.

[1:55] **Speaker:** Well, I've known [Partner's Name] since first year college.

[2:00] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[2:02] **Speaker:** Naging–naging boyfriend-girlfriend kami na first year college, ta's we broke up and we—we met each other again... mga [6-10] years? [6-10] years after.

[2:16] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[2:16] **Speaker:** Or in–teka [16-20]... hindi–mga [1-5] (or) [6-10] years pala, sorry. Hindi ko masyadong maalala 'yong exact.

[2:23] **Interviewer:** Opo. Tapos 'yong time po na 'yon in-between, wala po kayong contact?

[2:30] **Speaker:** In-between that, no'ng–no'ng nag-work siya, she got me as her [occupation]. But ganoon lang, parang—and then before naman, 'di ba, not as high-tech as now to keep communications going. So, yeah.

[2:52] **Interviewer:** So, mayroon po ba kayong anak?

[2:55] **Speaker:** Yes, we have [1-5] daughters.

[2:56] **Interviewer:** Opo. Pwede po ba naming malaman kung paano niyo po tinatawag si [Partner's Name]? Ano pong tawag mo sa kanya?

[3:04] **Speaker:** Beside [Partner's Name]—[Nickname].

[3:08] **Interviewer:** Opo. May we know din po, ilan po kayong magkasama sa bahay?

[3:13] **Speaker:** Sa—in our house, our family, me, [Partner's Name], and our [1-5] daughters. And then, since nagkaroon—since the start of pandemic, my mom stayed with us. Kasi, widow siya, e. So, she stays—she lives in—'yong [location]—bahay kasi 'yong [location] namin. Parang—it's like a building type. So, sa taas, like, her residence and then sa baba 'yong [location]. I had to come to account to bring her here na lang kasi—'di ba noong start—'yong lockdown, lockdown. So, it's very hard for her to be alone. Kasi wala siyang—

[3:51] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[3:52] **Speaker:** Kasi wala talagang kasama. So yeah.

[3:54] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[3:55] **Speaker:** So I—we invited her to stay with us.

[3:59] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[4:00] **Speaker:** Since we have the spare room naman talaga downstairs for her to use.

[4:04] **Interviewer:** Ah, para sa kanya po talaga?

[4:07] **Speaker:** Actually, we have a spare room downstairs. So, it's either my mom or [Partner's Name]'s mom before or—basta may spare room for guests.

[4:17] **Interviewer:** Opo, whenever they visit, 'no?

[4:20] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[4:21] **Interviewer:** Opo. So ngayon po may—

[4:22] **Speaker:** May—we have [1-5]—and then we [1-5] have—we have [1-5] household help pala, sorry.

[4:26] **Interviewer:** Opo. So seven...

[4:29] **Speaker:** So that's—[6-10] kami dito sa house, yeah.

[4:31] **Interviewer:** Opo. May we ask po also, what do you do for work?

[4:36] **Speaker:** I am a [occupation]. We have some—I run our [occupation].

[4:41] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, for our official question po, 'no—for the interview, may we know po your love story? Ayan. Pwede niyo po bang i-kwento ang love story ninyo ni [Partner's Name]?

[4:53] **Speaker:** Hmm. Love story. Paano bang ano—like how we met? Like that?

[4:58] **Interviewer:** Opo. How you met...

[5:00] **Speaker:** Oo.

[5:00] **Interviewer:** Paano po kayo nag-ka-develop-an, ganoon?

[5:03] **Speaker:** Hmm... actually, in college, I met her in—yeah, like I said, [year] of college, syempre attraction—physically, I got attracted to her, got to know her, and then, 'yon, ligaw ligaw. And then, we got—we—we were together for—I'm very poor with dates kasi, kaya—and time—but I think mga, a year or so. And then—and then 'yong broke up, and then, 'yon, after a while, nag-'yong—like I said earlier, I was her client sa work niya, and then, doon kami nagkakaroon ng contact.

[5:47] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[5:48] **Speaker:** And then, came to a point na parang... 'yong—paano ba 'yon—ako 'yong naging single.

[5:58] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[5:59] **Speaker:** At... well, at that time 'nong naging client niya ako, I was seeing someone, she was seeing someone also.

[6:04] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[6:05] **Speaker:** So, 'yon. Actually, may [intelligible] na parang maraming chance—parang—hindi—paano ba—some say na, parang, destiny or some say chances, 'di ba?

[6:17] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[6:18] **Speaker:** There was a very one unforgettable incident between us na—for her work, they had a conference, and I was her client, I was invited. On the way home—separate cars—we—I saw her nga, e. She—

[6:37] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[6:38] **Speaker:** She had a flat tire and I was able to help her. And then, parang do'n kami ulit, medyo nagkausap-usap ulit.

[6:45] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[6:46] **Speaker:** So, parang 'yong—andaming mga chance meetings, and then—after that, andaming mga chance meetings. And then, yeah, parang gano'n. And, basically, the rest is history.

[6:57] **Interviewer:** Pang movie po pa lang 'yong ano, 'no? Bali 'yong second encounter. Pang movie.

[7:02] **Speaker:** Oo. Actually, nakakatawa nga. Parang—who would've thought, 'di ba? I mean, along [Location] area—wala pa 'yong [Name] no'n, e.

[7:12] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[7:12] **Speaker:** It used to be the [Location], and I think, [Location] was under construction, then.

[7:17] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[7:17] **Speaker:** Ta's parang, napako siya—na-flat. And then, she needed assistance. Nadaanan ko na siya, e, tapos parang sabi ko 'si [Partner's Name] yata 'yon ah'. Went back again.

[7:24] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[7:25] **Speaker:** And help—help her change her tire so she could get home.

[7:29] **Interviewer:** Opo. 'Yong first break up niyo po no'ng ano—no'ng college, 'no—ano po 'yong mga reason po, doon?

[7:36] **Speaker:** Ayan, medyo—medyo immature pa tayo—kung ano—ano—

[7:40] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[7:41] **Speaker:** Kung ano-anong reason diyan. Yeah, like, 'yong—ako I can remember parang—one is different barkadas, kasi iba 'yong barkada niya, iba 'yong parang gano'n, so—anyway parang—yeah, for me, shallow lang kasi gimik namin ito, gusto nila gano'n so, you know. Bata pa kasi no'n.

[8:03] **Interviewer:** Ah, magkaiba po kayo ng, ano, trip dati gano'n?

[8:08] **Speaker:** Ibang—well, kami siguro hindi, but, sets of friends, 'di ba?

[8:11] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[8:11] **Speaker:** Iba 'yong friends nila, iba 'yong friends namin. 'Yon, parang gano'n.

[8:18] **Interviewer:** No'ng naging kayo po ulit, na-isip niyo po ba dati na, 'ba't pa tayo nag-hiwalay pa'—may mga gano'n po ba kayong thoughts?

[8:26] **Speaker:** Yeah, actually, napag-ano, na ano, na ano—'yong—'yong—'yong—'yong—'yong mga issues nga dati na parang pagtawanan na lang, 'di ba? 'Yong... or more so like—ano—'yong—like—ma-gimik dati—ma-gimik ako before, but siya parang more of a homebody. 'Yong parang gano'n. Kasi very strict din 'yong parents niya no'n. I think she wasn't allowed yet to go out so much. So, 'yong mga gano'n na parang palaging nasa labas. Kung saan-saan—well, siyempre, parang barkada, maraming friends, gano'n. And then, interacting with high school at saka college friends. Tapos may mga activities pa—may mga sports.

[9:13] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[9:15] **Speaker:** So, 'yon, parang—yeah, well, that's what I could recall.

[9:21] **Interviewer:** Opo. No'ng after po ng mga movie episode niyo po, 'no, tapos mga chance encounters, did you immediately feel na mukhang magiging kayo ulit?

[9:33] **Speaker:** Actually, more on, ano, parang—nag start muna sa usap-usap na 'yong—'yong—'yong—you felt—for one, you know her na, 'di ba? Parang, siyempre, previously—and then, parang on that stage of

your life, parang 'yong mas mature na. Parang mas marami na napapag-usapan. Mas maraming palang–parang we rediscovered each other, kasi parang 'di naman lahat gano'n.

[10:01] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[10:01] **Speaker:** 'Di naman, ano, so, yeah,

[10:05] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[10:08] **Speaker:** It helped also na, parang, I knew her brothers also, so, parang, hindi masyadong–ano–very welcoming din–'yong mabilis lang din maano sa family, kasi 'yong two other brothers niya, nakaka-interact ko–may similar hobbies, gano'n. So, parang gano'n. Something like that.

[10:27] **Interviewer:** Opo. So madali po 'yong parang, ano, rapport with the family.

[10:32] **Speaker:** Yes. Parang hindi rin naman tayo na-bad shot sa parents niya no'ng time na 'yon.

[10:38] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[10:38] **Speaker:** So, no'ng nakita ulit, 'oh, ikaw pala 'yan'. Before kasi–

[10:41] **Interviewer:** Happy sila.

[10:43] **Speaker:** Well, hindi ko naman masasabing happy, but, you know, parang sabihin nating hindi naman tayo 'yong parang wanted sa bahay nila, gano'n, so...

[10:53] **Interviewer:** Opo. May we ask po also, kamusta naman po 'yong quality ng relationship niyo ni [Partner's Name] if you compare it to your other friends na mga may asawa rin or in a relationship?

[11:08] **Speaker:** Actually, I believe na it's still a work in progress, 'di ba? Nothing is ano naman. As we grow older, different scenarios, different ano, so... yeah–well, generally, okay naman. Siyempre hindi rin nawawala 'yong mga away-away and everything.

[11:32] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[11:33] **Speaker:** But, generally, okay naman, okay naman tayo.

[11:36] **Interviewer:** Mayro'n po ba kayong friends, for example, na 'pag nakikita niyo, parang as a couple, naisip niya po ba na, 'ay buti pa 'tong mga 'to'. Kumbaga, okay 'yong relationship nila, or do you also see other friends—who are your couple friends na makikita niyo na poor 'yong relationship nila talaga?

[12:02] **Speaker:** Actually, ako hindi ako masyadong maano sa ganyan.

[12:05] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[12:06] **Speaker:** More I see is 'yong what we have. Sometimes, we talked about—we talk about other people, but hindi–ako, I personally do not compare so much kasi.

[12:19] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[12:20] **Speaker:** At this point in time, I do believe na mas magfocus kami sa sarili namin to–

[12:28] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[12:29] **Speaker:** For example, if there is issues and everything, and then[intelligible]—and for things to work out, dapat adjustment amongst us ni [Partner's Name]. Hindi kasi parang... well, isang adjustment is like 'yong lumalabas-labas—I cannot say na 'yong—'yong core friends ko are still allowed to go out once a week and I'm not because of 'yong—let's say—so, yeah. Para lang—para—for—siguro to keep the peace—para hindi na lang mag-away, gano'n. Make some adjustments na lang.

[13:07] **Interviewer:** Opo. So may we know po also, ilan po 'yong naging ka-relationship niyo dati—ilan po 'yong mga naging ex ninyo?

[13:18] **Speaker:** Hmm... [1-5]? Officially, parang [1-5], oo. Si [Partner's Name], and then, there was three, and then, si [Partner's Name] ulit.

[13:28] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, if you're going to compare po, 'no, 'yong relationship with your mga exes compared to [Partner's Name]. Ayan. How is it like po? In terms of quality?

[13:42] **Speaker:** Actually... mahirap i-compare kasi, siguro before parang boyfriend-girlfriend lang, but now—now, married life with kids and family. Hindi ko rin siguro masasabi kung how it would transpire before with other people, so...

[13:58] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[13:59] **Speaker:** Parang gano'n, yeah.

[14:04] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, paano niyo po masasabi, for example, na mataas ang quality ng isang relationship?

[14:11] **Speaker:** Siguro, happy—if everybody's happy in the relationship parang—'yon nga parang—how do you describe it? Kung good quality, 'yong wala masyadong problem, wala masyadong—kasi we put into consideration naman—hindi pwedeng one way lang, 'di ba? Isa lang 'yong masaya, gano'n.

[14:32] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[14:33] **Speaker:** So, we learn also to, parang, give and take para everybody happy, and then, especially now, the kids are growing up.

[14:44] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[14:44] **Speaker:** Parang nowadays kasi, unlike before, how we grew up, parang 'yong opinion ng kids now are so much heavy. Ako no'ng maliit ako, hindi naman ako tinatanong ng parents ko kung saan ako kakain, e, basta kung gusto kumain, sasabihin nila 'that's where we'll eat', 'di ba?

[14:59] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[14:59] **Speaker:** Parang that's the culture we grew up with, but now, parang, yeah. Parang, we ask, 'di ba? We ask them and they have a lot of say in things. For me, it's fine din naman. At least, we get to know them more, we get to hear them more, we know more of their interest, and then, somehow, at least the

time spent with each other is still okay. Kasi 'di ba mayro'ng iba, parang, lumaki na 'yong kids, parang hindi na nila—parang ayaw na sila kasama—I don't like that to happen.

[15:37] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Paano niyo naman po masasabi kung mababa ang quality ng isang relationship?

[15:45] **Speaker:** Paanong mababa? Parang not good, gano'n?

[15:48] **Interviewer:** Opo. Not good, ganyan.

[15:48] **Speaker:** Unhappy?

[15:50] **Interviewer:** If they're unhappy. Mhmm. Ano po sa tingin niyo 'yong nangyayari sa isang unhappy relationship, unhappy marriage?

[16:03] **Speaker:** Siguro ano, they don't get what they want. Parang—kasi... hindi rin siguro balanced, 'di ba? Like, for me, it's clear that my responsibility is to provide well for the family. Siguro din, ano, isang relationship masasabi ko now compared to some of my friends, having kids is really a big part of making the relationship work, making it better, biggest reason to fight for it to continue. Kasi I have a good friend who doesn't have a kid so parang—wala—parang kung may problema, nothing to fight for. Parang companionship lang, 'di ba? Kung pwede siya [intelligible], pwede siyang hindi umuwi kasi—

[16:57] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[16:59] **Speaker:** Parang bahala ka na siyang muna.

[17:00] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[17:00] **Speaker:** You have your own space—my space. When we have kids, it's clear na they get involved, they get affected also so...

[17:12] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[17:13] **Speaker:** Minsan na-se-set aside 'yong parang, you could say, selfish intentions or reasons na parang—anyway, since we like to nurture and make the kids grow up as okay and balance as possible. So parang, end goal, me as a person, on top of what I do professionally, is, I want din na, parang, 'yong reward ko is my kids turn out really well when they grow up.

[17:43] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[17:44] **Speaker:** So 'yon 'yong parang isang—isang avenue na finofocus ko.

[17:47] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, kumbaga parang isa po sa—kumbaga why there's an active effort on your part to work on the marriage, ano man 'yong mga challenges, kasi at the end of the day, parang 'yong mga bata, 'no, they'll be—kumbaga, whatever relationship of the mom and dad, it will have an effect on them.

[18:13] **Speaker:** Mhmm. Mhmm.

[18:14] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[18:15] **Speaker:** Lalo na now, the kids are older na—the eldest is [16-20], the second one is [11-15], so they get to voice out also. So, parang their point is co-parenting or separated. Yeah, it works now but it doesn't—for them, we give them a choice, they don't like it also. That plays a very big part to me, it weighs on me very heavily.

[18:46] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, parang it's something that you have talked about as a family?

[18:52] **Speaker:** Well, minsan kasi there will be some days na bad days will reach to the point na ano—but in the end, when you talk about it—I'm not ano rin e—I'm not so good at talking about personal things.

[19:11] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[19:11] **Speaker:** Siguro because of me losing my dad at a young age, and then my mom had to work to provide for the family. Tapos ako 'yong panganay.

[19:24] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[19:25] **Speaker:** So parang, took in—took in another responsibilities early on. So, parang—yeah ako, feeling ko parang may void ako, so I try to make it up na lang to—parang, ano ba—service, gano'n like right now, as my eldest goes to college and the youngest goes to high school—before I'd bring them to school every day. Before one school lang e, so now two schools. So, I make it a point, I move things around talaga to be available for them.

[20:00] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[20:00] **Speaker:** But see, the eldest will eventually be driving and be able to go to school, but while she's still practicing and everything, or all the chance that I get to participate with them, I—I move things around and participate with them. So, parang gano'n.

[20:18] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Opo, ang galing naman. So, ano po, sige po, next question. Parang sa inyo po, ano 'yong mga pinakamahalagang bagay sa isang relasyon? And bakit ito importante?

[20:33] **Speaker:** Siguro, pinakamahalaga is 'yong understanding—understanding—to understand why we do things, why we have to—parang—parang madalas mapag-usapan kasi yan—there's always a choice—there's always an option, but, sometimes in the line of work, or 'yong interaction mo, or 'yong pakisama sa ibang tao, nawawalan tayo ng choice because we have to do things. So, sometimes I ask for that understanding, like, minsan hindi naman sa parang gusto natin na we're always out, we're always full sa schedule, gano'n.

[21:14] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[21:14] **Speaker:** 'Di ba? But... then—but—saka ano, e, isa pa yan, as we age, 'di ba 'yong—'yong physically, minsan pagod

[21:27] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[21:27] **Speaker:** Nag-c-creep in din 'yong pagod. Minsan parang we start our day five in the morning, I bring the kids to school. Minsan—

[21:34] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[21:34] **Speaker:** When you come home 11 in the evening, with a full day at work, 'pag nag-wash ako, 'pag nasandal ka, minsan, nakakatulog na talaga.

[21:43] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[21:44] **Speaker:** So, that's something that I'm trying to balance out right now.

[21:50] **Interviewer:** Opo, talagang busy po 'yong ano, 'yong everyday niyo po 'no? Kasi that's—kumbaga, responsibilities as a father, tapos work pa, 'di ba? So, nagsasama-sama po, 'no?

[22:02] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[22:04] **Interviewer:** So, ayon. Masasabi po namin na nais namin malaman, ano po ang mahalaga sa isang relasyon, ano naman po sa tingin niyo 'yong mga bagay na nagpapatatag sa isang relationship?

[22:19] **Speaker:** Well, siguro, one would be goals, 'di ba? 'Yong end goals for everything. Like I was mentioning earlier, the kids is one of our main goals—to—to provide them with—not like financial—provide them well, to be equipment for the future, 'di ba? Pagtatag din sa relationship is 'yong family values that we have.

[22:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[22:49] **Speaker:** Syempre, we'd like to—to continue rin, 'di ba? Para maayos.

[22:59] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[23:01] **Speaker:** At saka communication, try to—try to communicate as much. Pero yan, I—I would say na, medyo kulang ako diyan, but—

[23:10] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[23:12] **Speaker:** Na-understand ko na, it's also critical.

[23:15] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Were there po changes with how you communicate with your family, especially with your wife po? Compared to then and now.

[23:25] **Speaker:** Changes?

[23:27] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[23:31] **Speaker:** Well, yeah, I'm trying to learn to be more articulate, like 'yong communication for one, I could think of is—medyo independent kasi ako na tao, e, so—

[23:44] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[23:45] **Speaker:** Once I go out, isang problem na palagay namin napapag-awayan is 'yong nakakalimutan ko mag-update. So minsan, tuloy-tuloy na 'yong kausap. One meeting after the other, tapos may tasks na minomonitor sa office, gano'n. Minsan nakakalimutan ko to say, 'I'm done with this', 'I'm doing that', 'I'm

going there', 'I'm going here'. Well, nahirapan ako doon kasi parang minsan tuloy-tuloy—or parang, I have this notion in my mind na, parang, marami na 'kong ginagawa—

[24:23] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[24:23] **Speaker:** Sasabihin ko pa sa 'yo. Tapos minsan, lalo pang humahaba 'yong usapan na, parang, hindi naman mahaka-help or something like that, but—

[24:32] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[24:32] **Speaker:** It's viewed differently, so I'm just trying to adjust.

[24:35] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So parang ano po 'yong sa inyo, 'no, parang solution-focused, mga ganyan, problem solving type.

[24:43] **Speaker:** Oo, kasi parang—kasi parang wala naman—parang—hindi naman natin, parang, i-insist, 'di ba? Parang... 'yon. You end up, parang, in arguments lang din. So, hanggang sa kaya nga, we'll—we'll—we'll work on it, work on the solution, make some adjustments.

[25:06] **Interviewer:** Opo. So kapag po na-b-bring up right now or before 'yong communication problems na parang, hindi ka na naman nag-update or of that sort, how do you usually react po?

[25:20] **Speaker:** Hmm... No, I just say sorry. I just say sorry for...

[25:24] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[25:26] **Speaker:** Hindi na ako nag-explain. I just say sorry na lang kasi—before kasi, I'll say na, ano, 'you can check naman with the people at the office' or ano, 'di ba, parang, most people that we interact with, parang kilala rin naman ni [Partner's Name] or something. Pero, hindi ko ma-ano 'yong arguments nya na—well for her, basta hindi—she wants it like that, e hindi ko nga minsan nagagawa.

[25:55] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[25:57] **Speaker:** Let's say moving from one place to the other, I drive. I don't have a driver, so parang...

[26:02] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[26:04] **Speaker:** Issue rin 'yon na, 'you can reply to other people when they're talking to you, but why don't you message me?' 'Yon nga, parang dati kasi pumapasok sa kanya—kasi 'yong sinasagutan ko na tao, kasi 'yon 'yong pupuntahan kong kausap, so if ever they ask, 'where are you', 'are you on your way', 'di ba? Parang no'ng for just you to ask me na... 'yong parang magsabi ka lang na 'from this place to this place, I'm gonna go na', parang medyo na s-skip ko 'yon, so...

[26:30] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[26:33] **Speaker:** Medyo malaking gulo palagi, so...

[26:35] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[26:37] **Interviewer:** 'Pag di kayo po nakaka-update. So para sa inyo po, ano ang love? What is love or pag-ibig? Ganyan.

[26:47] **Speaker:** Love? Siguro 'yong love at my age right now, kasi parang as you grow, parang nag-iiba rin, 'di ba? But for me, love is 'yong caring, 'di ba? 'You look after someone, you protect and provide, 'di ba? Plus, 'yong love is 'yong showing affection, 'di ba? Siguro, masyado akong naka-focus to provide the needs. So, isa pinaka-focus ko 'yon, na if I lack sa ibang department, at least I make it up for providing well for my children and my family, giving what they need, helping out if they have wants or problems, 'di ba? Parang gano'n.

[27:41] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So parang 'yon din po 'yong kumbaga love language niyo po, ano?

[27:47] **Speaker:** Yes, actually, na-discuss nga sa akin 'yon. Love language, pero siguro, before 'yong love language hindi naman masyadong na-co-consider 'yong mga gano'n lang. But yeah, I could say na, ano, service—yeah, service 'yong...

[28:05] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[28:07] **Speaker:** Love language natin.

[28:09] **Interviewer:** What about si, ano po, si [Partner's Name] po? What is her love language?

[28:15] **Speaker:** What she wants ba? You're asking?

[28:17] **Interviewer:** Opo. How does she express her, parang, love to you? Gano'n.

[28:24] **Speaker:** Hmm... she, ano, parang maglalambing siya or like that. But, yeah, parang something like that.

[28:35] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So parang interaction, quality time.

[28:40] **Speaker:** Oo—yeah, yeah. 'Yon 'yong—yeah, parang gano'n. That's what she wants. Parang interaction, quality time, dapat spend a lot of—spend a lot of time together, gano'n, gano'n.

[28:54] **Interviewer:** Opo. Tapos kayo po service naman?

[28:57] **Speaker:** Oo. Kaya [intelligible]

[28:59] **Interviewer:** Parang ano... opo. Interesting po, 'no? Kasi parang medyo in conflict ang inyong love language.

[29:05] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[29:05] **Interviewer:** So, parang for you, you provide. Siya naman 'okay, we have to be together.' Ganyan.

[29:10] **Speaker:** Yes.

[29:11] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[29:12] **Speaker:** Actually, ano, I would admit na nandyan 'yong issue, especially with time.

[29:18] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[29:19] **Speaker:** Siguro, minsan I put into consideration also 'yong race kasi I'm pure [Nationality], 'di ba, she's [Nationality]. So parang 'yong work ethics and values ng mga [Nationality] are medyo palaging nagta-trabaho—parang even with my family, if we're together, we can't help—we can't help it but talk about work, business, gano'n because...

[29:45] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[29:47] **Speaker:** That—that's what we try in terms of 'yong business, community, you know, contacts and everything. But since sila, mas ano sila. Parang 'pag family time, they don't talk about work parang gano'n, so.

[30:00] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[30:01] **Speaker:** So, 'yon din 'yong na-encounter namin since my mom's staying with us. Sometimes over dinner table, my mom would ask me, 'oh kilala mo si ano 'di ba?', gano'n gan'on. Like that. Or may issue sila sa work na I'm part of the company also, na minsan iniwasan na mag-di-discuss na parang I'm clearly told na they find—si [Partner's Name] and ano—they find it offensive daw na why do we talk about those things in the dinner table. So on my part, I just try to adjust na lang.

[30:36] **Interviewer:** Opo. So parang on that part, cultural differences po 'no? So parang with you and your mom po, parang work, it's still part of the family, 'no? It's not necessarily separate.

[30:51] **Speaker:** Ah, yes. Kasi, ano, [occupation] people kasi kami lahat, e. Parang compared to other families na professionals, they work on different—like [1-5] siblings—they—one works for a [company], one is an [occupation], one's an [occupation]. So, parang, there's no relationship between their work. 'Di ba?

[31:11] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[31:13] **Speaker:** For us, we have a [company], which I take part in also, and I have my own companies also. Some of our—well two of my other [company] are in relations with our [company].

[31:29] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[31:30] **Speaker:** And then, I somehow lead the [company] also on a day-to-day—well not on a day-to-day basis, parang I'm the [occupation] of the company. Tapos, my brother and—my mom said [to] take part, kasi 'yon, bored din siya wala siya ginagawa. So parang—

[31:45] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[31:46] **Speaker:** Since during the daytime, lalo na ngayon pandemic—before kasi, during lunch, sabay-sabay kami nag-la-lunch sa office kasi sama-sama kami, but now, we're like, my mom doesn't go to the office yet.

[31:56] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[31:58] **Speaker:** She still stays at home. So minsan pag-uwi ko, 'yong chance for interaction is napupunta do'n sa ano na—we try, even my mom, we try to adjust na—na talk about it over ano. 'Yong kung—we try to talk about it privately na lang.

[32:19] **Interviewer:** Opo. But is it something that surprised you, you know, na parang in the [Nationality] culture, hiwalay ang work life tapos for you guys, for [Nationality] people, 'di ba po? It's not necessarily that separate.

[32:35] **Speaker:** Well, siguro, mas na-feel ko lang yan na ano—na now na nag-s-stay 'yong mom ko here with us.

[32:40] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[32:41] **Speaker:** Kasi before, kung wala siya, wala naman pinag-u-usapan, but siyempre ako, ano ko rin 'yon to interact with, like...

[32:49] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[32:51] **Speaker:** With my mom, siyempre, [intelligible] may tatanungin siya or like to discuss something about it.

[32:56] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[32:57] **Speaker:** Yeah. Ever since siguro dahil 'yon nga, for one, I'm the first born. Tapos, I lost my dad at the age of nine. So, parang...

[33:05] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[33:07] **Speaker:** Early on, kung may mga ganiyang ano, my brother and sister also talk to me about anything under the sun regarding—minsan nga nasasabi na parang ang dami mong kinakausap, pero for me, it's just—that's—that's the life that I grew up with. So parang for me, it's just—it's just another day, 'di ba?

[33:25] **Interviewer:** Opo. Not necessarily separate.

[33:28] **Speaker:** Yeah.

[33:29] **Interviewer:** So has the adjustment been difficult po for you, 'no, parang of course instead of, you know, openly talking about work at home, is it something you had difficulty with?

[33:41] **Speaker:** Well, ang problem is sometimes I forget, 'di ba? Parang, sometimes you get—there are exciting days, there are some days that you—there are good days and bad, we could say it like that. And syempre, minsan you'd like to express also, 'di ba, kasi parang wala ka namang ibang kausap. So [intelligible], alangan naman you talk about problem with your staff, 'di ba? Parang gano'n.

[34:02] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[34:02] **Speaker:** So, parang, syempre issues, guidance—like for example, mayro'n tayong—up to now, we could say... the business platform everywhere's still constantly changing.

[34:18] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[34:19] **Speaker:** 'Yong norms natin [Year]—before—before [Year], even though we see a lot of activities now, wala pa rin 'yong stability, in terms of projections, targets and everything. So work even with prediction with clients and their needs, malayo pa rin. So hindi pa tayo normal, 'di ba?

[34:41] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[34:41] **Speaker:** Syempre medyo key 'yon e, key sa amin 'yon, dahil syempre you have to think about those. If you do not—you—you cannot just leave things day by day, if you have to set targets, you have to—well, isip, 'di ba? We have to think extra. So yeah, syempre minsan mayro'n ding kaunting ano na, lalo na now that my kids are growing up, we're trying to do some activities na like more on social media, 'di ba?

[35:12] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[35:13] **Speaker:** Like sa [Social Media] and everything. E, ang feeling ko naman since there's more—we spend more time there. Syempre, I get inputs from them.

[35:21] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[35:22] **Speaker:** So, parang—parang ako hindi ko rin alam kasi, syempre I see them always watching,

[35:29] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[35:29] **Speaker:** How do you do those things ba? I mean, how do you—I mean, is that effective ba? And then, syempre you get inputs from them. E, I feel na learning din naman sila e, they have their own opinions, they can share your—your suggestions also.

[35:44] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[35:45] **Speaker:** So, maga—ma-gano'n ako, e. Parang 'pag naguusap, ma-ano ko na tao. So...

[35:51] **Interviewer:** Parang 'yong the learning—parang you try to get it from different sources, not just from formal settings, ganyan.

[36:02] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[36:02] **Interviewer:** So, sa bahay—kasi parang—parang groundwork, parang fieldwork sa bahay.

[36:07] **Speaker:** Yeah, yeah. Oo.

[36:08] **Interviewer:** You tend to do your own research, ask your daughter about it.

[36:14] **Speaker:** Kasi parang in anything, like—like you're doing research also differently, 'di ba? Syempre, how could we, parang, for example, our product, this is catered to just one specific market. And then, we—part of our business is involved with marketing, advertising, 'yong interaction. Kasi, one of our business is suppose—is, parang, service bureau kami na mga companies to print, fabricate, do shows, exhibits, products. So, syempre, sometimes, naisip ko rin na with the changes sa pandemic, with all the online, 'is the market of our business still viable ba?' 'Is people shifting online na?' No need for physical—no need to see posters, brochures, parang 'di ba?

[37:06] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[37:07] **Speaker:** I mean, saan mo naman makukuka 'yong...

[37:10] **Interviewer:** Opo. 'Yong input.

[37:13] **Speaker:** Yeah. 'Di ba, parang, you would ask. Like for example, instead I'll ask you, when you buy something now, would you still ask for a brochure or you just look it up online? 'Di ba, parang, those are the things that you ponder on, because we print brochures. So, parang, are we seeing the end of it na? It would be just, 'yong parang, you know. On a daily...

[37:33] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[37:35] **Speaker:** Typical day at work, parang, syempre, mabenta or mahina, baka, iba na kasi ginagamit ng mga tao or something like that. Yeah.

[37:42] **Interviewer:** So, parang, ano, the learning curve is ongoing, especially pandemic, digital age. So, parang, with our interview right now, I can see how passionate you are with your work as well, 'no po. Parang, is it something, for example, that's been being a source of conflict naman in your relationship po?

[38:07] **Speaker:** For me, I don't know if they would agree. We—we will not survive. Hindi tayo mabubuhay—like my late father would tell me, 'hindi kayo mabubuhay na nagyayakapan at nagmamahalan sa bahay. I mean, it's just the hard facts. You know, we have needs, we have wants, we have to—I don't know with other people, but I do believe na, even on a given day, 'di ba? You stay outside the whole day, kung wala kang ginawa, ni piso, hindi mo nang mapupulot 'yon, e.

[38:45] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[38:46] **Speaker:** It's a simple fact na, I believe in. Syempre, I would state even the—even sila [Name] and sila [Name] and [Name], continuously learn every day. That's why they travel so much, they interact so much. So, for you to maintain where you are, constantly, so, siguro, that's a given na hindi ko ic-change. Kasi for me, I believe na, whatever happens, I will still need to provide for everyone. So, I don't know if I'm right or wrong, but I don't know other any way as na—example, waking up in the mornings, I cannot just sleep in up to—on a regular weekday, kung hindi ko hina—kasi, now may school, we wake up at 5:30, 5:45, to prepare for school, but kung walang school, 7:30, I'd like to be up and about, ready to take calls.

[39:52] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[39:53] **Speaker:** Yeah, but, minsan na-a-ano ni [Partner's Name] na parang, 'wala ba tayong day na you'd sleep in', but I'm already awake, I'm already, ano...

[40:01] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[40:04] **Speaker:** Ako kasi I believe what we have right now, we got it through hard work, it wasn't—what I have now wasn't given to me by my parents, I did not inherit anything. We were able to move out from my mom's house, early on, to have our own house, to have everything, na, 'yong, everything that we have now. We like to travel, we like to eat, we like to, ano—e, ako clearly, very clear saka niyo na, without hard work, these things won't come.

[40:40] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[40:40] **Speaker:** 'Yong, sometimes nga umaabot kami sa usapan na, baka dapat you look for a professional who works 8 to 5, and then when they come home, whatever—masunong man 'yong office nila, it doesn't matter, because I mean, tomorrow, they'll still be employed, 'di ba?

[40:56] **Interviewer:** Yeah. Mhmm.

[40:58] **Speaker:** Parang palitan lang naman 'yan, e. Ako, I will say na, if you're an employee, you get fixed amount of income. 'Yong sinasahod mo na isang taon, makukuha ko ng isang buwan 'yan, 'pag sinuwerte tayo—if we get good deals, medyo peak, 'di ba? And then, nag-e-enjoy din ako, for example, travel, we get to travel 7 days straight. I mean, because mas na-ma-manage properly 'yong mga plan niyo sa work. I—I can move things around, that's what I always say. Hindi naman ako, 'yong parang, limited 'yong leaves ko sa office, 'yong mga gano'n, so, medyo parang, gano'n-gano'n lang 'yong mga...

[41:40] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[41:40] **Speaker:** Yeah, actually, I've—I've—madalas um-ano 'yan na parang, can't I adjust, or let go, or ano, parang, natatakot din ako. I mean, it's very hard to create something. Once you have it, it's also hard to maintain, maybe medyo, ma-hirap i-understand, because they are not there every day, they don't see how things are. Parang, kaya nga we teach the kids value of money, e. Parang, 'yong, sabihin natin, something, it's just 1,000 pesos, it's just 2,000 pesos. Like, given a chance, can you—can you look for that, in a day, 'yong, 'yong—hindi ko naman sila [intelligible], pero I mean—at least they have this notion of, parang, even though I have this in my wallet, I mean, I just don't fork it out and then tomorrow's gonna be another day.

[42:34] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[42:36] **Speaker:** I don't know if I'm going off-topic, sorry.

[42:38] **Interviewer:** Parang, ano po e—kasi parang, with you po, it's important, kasi, it's part of your, kumbaga, it's part of your—of you as an individual, e. 'Yong work, 'no, and work ethic, kumbaga, it's not just something you present in a workplace, 'no. Kasi, kumbaga, there are some parts of—for example, of your work ethic that came from the household, 'di ba? It was developed throughout the years with your experience. So, kumbaga, parang, how you are at work is applicable at home. How you are at home is applicable at work. So, parang, nag-i-intertwine po siya, no? It may seem off tangent, but not necessarily. Kasi, for example po, with—parang, with your—how you are as a parent and as a husband, 'di ba? You try to keep it together by providing. So, in the process of providing, you have to maintain what you have built. And because kayo po 'yong mismoong tao, who oversees everything, you also know, kumbaga, what are the things needed in order for you to build that. Kumbaga, you can somehow anticipate ano 'yong mga puwedeng challenges na, you know, 'hindi natin to ma-maintain, ano 'yong magiging consequences,' no? And somehow you see, parang they are also the main people who will get, you know, severely affected.

[44:15] **Speaker:** Affected, yes.

[44:17] **Interviewer:** If you won't be able to keep the business. So, parang, I mean, parang, I can somehow see the difficulty with, for example, certain demands, like, 'why don't you spend time more—spend more time with us?' Ganiyan. But then, or somehow asking, or what if, hanap ka ng 8 to 5 person, 'di ba? But the fear is there, na if I get a person, 8 to 5, who they have the same level of, parang, being meticulous or care about something that you've built, lalo na, they won't be the one, you know, they didn't build it.

[44:58] **Speaker:** Yes.

[44:59] **Interviewer:** Magte-take over lang—

[45:00] **Speaker:** Actually—actually, we did try. I mean—and actually, it's—it's, I appreciate your—you—you kind of understand. Kasi, ano, it's as simple as hiring someone. We have—we have supervisors, we have managers, but, bottom line, if things go wrong, tayo rin ang kausap ng client, company rin natin 'yong affected. So, parang, might as well do it right the first time. That's usually may approach. And then, very time sensitive din 'yong work natin. For example, a brand will have a big launch. And then, you don't make it on time. What's the use of everything? They have a schedule. It's—it's—it's that simple.

[45:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[45:48] **Speaker:** 'Di ba, parang, fiesta. We're supposed to do the parade, and then, the collateral is from them. The fiesta is Sunday. You finish by Monday. What's the point of everything? And then, that'll be the end of it for you. I mean, you have that client who—who orders repetitively to you all throughout the year. Which gives you naman that assurance na, oh, medyo basta hanggang sa mayroon 'tong mga 'to, we're good. We're good at that, 'di ba? So, yeah, parang, 'yon 'yong—that's how I see it, kasi.

[46:22] **Interviewer:** Opo, and, parang, you also mentioned din naman kanina, it's not that, completely, wala 'yong family time, 'di ba? But it's something that you have to schedule, for example, through a vacation. Ganyan. And kumbaga, it's enjoying the fruits of your labor, 'no. 'Yon nga lang po 'yong, kumbaga, in an everyday—kung if we're going to look at it, iin an everyday setup, 'no, mayro'n talagang ma-co-compromise, like, for example, 'I can't watch Netflix with you,' 'I can't sit down, have a conversation, about this and that.' But, for example, you bring your daughters to school, 'di ba, that says something about wanting to spend time with them, because you can't make them ride a Grab, 'di ba.

[47:14] **Speaker:** Mhmm. Or ask them to take the school bus, or whatever.

[47:18] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[47:20] **Speaker:** Yeah. Ako naman I'm trying my best, like, this is starting in school, but, syempre, sa college and everything. 'Yon nga parang, for example, she has a class, or—I'll be there for her, basta, 'yon nga lang, I'll be on my phone, I'll be you know. But, 'yon nga, try to add up as much as possible, also, with technology. But, 'yong—kunwari minsan weekend off, you have a house in the province, or we can go Friday night hanggang Monday, gano'n, but, I have to be on the phone. 'Yong parang—'yong—well, hindi naman ako nasa phone the whole day. Pero, I mean, very, very hard—very hard to balance, kasi, I—I don't know if you would agree, but, it's not yet normal. I mean, and—and, nakakatakot din—we see big companies folding also. Well, for me, 'yon 'yong primary purpose ko, e. If the company folds up and I stay at home, anong—anong—what's my purpose, 'di ba? I mean...

[48:25] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[48:26] **Speaker:** I can say nobody can replace what I'm doing right now. Hindi ko naman siya b-in-a-brag, but it's just a fact na-na parang-parang, sabihin na-yeah, parang gano'n, like, for example, [Partner's Name] does this, pero, 'yong-for example, picking up the kids or doing the marketing or doing some other-hindi ko sinasabi na, parang, lesser, but dispensable siya, pero, kung nawala talaga source of income natin, medyo...

[48:58] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Major. Mhmm. So how do you resolve po, parang, whenever you have these conversations about ayon, lack of time, ganyan. How do you usually solve, 'yong mga nagiging sources of conflict po ninyo ni [Partner's Name]?

[49:14] **Speaker:** Well-well, 'yon nga, try-I try to-to make the necessary adjustments, but, minsan-minsan may days na magsasabay-sabay 'yan. Parang basically, running for companies, so, may araw talaga na sagad talaga. May araw na, parang, wala talagang ginagawa. So, 'yon 'yong-gano'n e, 'di ba, we cannot-may-may, like, may mga season-season siya, so, may nagp-peak ng 'ber' months, may nagp-peak ng summer, mayro'n siya-so, 'di ba, in-oh, well, I have to admit, nag-i-improve din. So, from [Year], lalo na [Year], up to now, nagi-improve din, so, ako, I keep it in mind also to learn to delegate more, to step back more, or to put in more parameters, to-to, parang, yeah, for example, 'yong may isang beses tayo na labor-intensive, so, before, I don't-lahat ng projects namin, iniikutan ko lahat 'yon. I'm never upset. But now, I-siguro matagal na rin 'yong tao sa amin, siguro, mayroon akong mga teams na [6-10] years na, [11-15] years na sa 'kin, so, medyo nagt-trust tayo nang kaunti. But, 'pag may critical pa rin na minsan maselan 'yong client, I still have a piece. Mas peaceful sa akin 'yong-ay parang mas may peace of mind ako na nakita ko man lang, physically, on one day, para 'pag tumawag sila, [intelligible] suggest kasi, we're putting up a signage, hindi mo man nakita kung saan 'yong building, 'yong-just, I mean, even though there's video, [Social Media], picture-I mean, e kung gano'n pala, e di 'yong mga [occupation] at saka [occupation], you just show them the floor plan, itayo na natin 'yong building.

[51:10] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. What about po 'yong mga-in a home setting naman, pag naman nag-away kayo ni Miss [Partner's Name], how do you resolve it?

[51:22] **Speaker:** Actually, I have to admit, hirap ako 'yong-ano-but, minsan I don't know what to do so much, dahil, sinasabi very practical, very ano, so... kulang daw sa lambing, or gano'n-or parang, suyo, gano'n. I'm trying, I'm really trying. Sometimes to say-but, yeah, she always says it's an excuse, but, sometimes, marami lang things going on, so, parang, may common na nangyayari sa amin in the morning, bago umalis, we-some misunderstanding, we'll start talking, or umaabot sa arguments na-I really cannot stay. May mga 9:30 to 10-'shit,' sinasabi nag-w-walk out ako, I really have to leave na. I mean-I mean, I don't know how to explain it, but things won't stop, and things cannot stop. 'Yong parang, ano, hindi ako puwedeng hindi umalis, kailangan ko gumalaw. Kung hindi ako gagalaw, hindi rin-and it's gonna be a domino effect na, hanggang 'yong-it's gonna-'yong effect no'n-again, sasabihin 'work na naman,' pero hindi ko nga alam, paano ba? Hindi ko puwede sabihin, 'sige, bahala na lang muna kayo sa trabaho diyan,' mag-usap kami hanggang sa-hanggang sa ma-settle namin 'yong issue, tapos, pahabulin ko na lang kayo. E, 'yon nga, like I mentioned earlier, time sensitive kasi 'yong trabaho natin, e. Parang, 'oh, it's your birthday to night, we're gonna set up the hotel for you,' and can I say na, 'I'm sorry, I wasn't able to go to

work this morning, I—I went to work two o'clock in the afternoon because I was talking to someone. I mean, I'm trying to preserve my marriage and I had to talk to my wife for five hours.' I mean, I don't know if—sabi ko nga, I'll just try, but if—if they see it na—that's gonna be the problem.

[53:20] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[53:22] **Speaker:** May—may kailangan akong gawin, e. Hindi naman ako...

[53:26] **Interviewer:** Are there certain steps po, parang with you actively trying, 'no, kasi, from our interview, I can sense that sinusubukan niyo po talaga, 'no? Kumbaga, you try to work on your marriage and at the same time, life—work must go on, 'no. It's not something optional na—that will be put on hold.

[53:50] **Speaker:** Yes.

[53:51] **Interviewer:** Are there any things na or mga ways that demonstrates that you are trying?

[54:01] **Speaker:** Ako—ako, I try as much as I can to be here at home, like to do online, hanggang sa maka—kasi, 'yan lang na lang ang kulang ko, kasi, for example, sa kids, I really prioritize them. I catch on meetings talaga to—if they have activities, if they have something. Minsan, kulang lang din talaga ng time, parang sabihin na, parang, minsan na-b-blur na nga 'yong quality time at saka 'yong kung may kailangan gawin. For example, there's some—there was one time, I got home around seven, and then, [Partner's Name] wanted to go to [Location], so we still went. I mean, no complaints on my part. Tapos, the following day, I had to do something na medyo na-late, so parang, naging issue is, like, 'ah porque pumunta ba tayo kahapon,' I—she would tell me, it's not considered as quality time, because we needed to go there to buy some things lang.

[54:57] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[54:58] **Speaker:** E, ako naman parang, okay, sige, e di—e di, sige—I mean, adjust pa tayo ulit, 'di ba? Parang, ano pa ba 'yong—ano pa bang puwedeng gawin, 'di ba? But, parang—parang 7:00 to—parang 7:00 to 12:00—parang magkasama naman kami, gano'n. For me, parang 'yon na rin 'yon e, pero it's so very defined e—very defined 'yong,

[55:20] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[55:24] **Speaker:** Ako, kaya ko sinasabing age 'yong pagdating sa maturity natin, parang, basta magkasama tayo, parang, pwede, 'yon na—magkasama. Hindi na 'yong parang, 'hindi, we had to buy, ano kasi, that's why we went there,' or 'we were looking at furniture, so that's why we went there.' So, that's, parang, paano ba tineterm? Obligation mo 'yon, to do that. Pero iba 'yong voluntary, 'di ba? Parang gano'n.

[55:55] **Interviewer:** Parang ano po, parang for you, as long as the two of you are together, or the whole family is together, that's already considered as quality time.

[56:05] **Speaker:** Well, hindi naman quality, parang basta magkasama, 'di ba? I mean, parang ako, I doubt myself na pagdating sa pagsasabi na quality time, kasi I feel na parang hindi ko yata nakikita 'yong—'yong difference na ano... kaya yan, 'yong siguro defects. Parang that's something also na I'd like to find time with—is 'yong—'yong—'yong maraming sinasabi si [Partner's Name] sa akin na, I'm—I'm a narcissist, I'm—I'm

depressed. So, I'd like to find time also, pero, very time goes, 'yong [intelligible] 'yong to find the psych—ano, to get myself tested sa mga persona—'yong behavioral ano, baka there's something wrong with me, maybe, consider na ask professional help, gano'n. She would tell me those. So, minsan na-ano rin ako, kasi hindi—minsan napapaisip, kasi hindi ko na—no one has ever told me those.

[57:10] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[57:11] **Speaker:** Lalo na 'yong, parang, being depressed and everything, hindi ko naisip 'yon, kasi feeling ko, I still function naman, 'di ba? I mean, I lead—nagkakaroon ng [intelligible] some aspects na, you know, she finds, or what, once na hindi ko na-p-provide, but it doesn't mean that there's something psychologically, or personally wrong with myself.

[57:31] **Interviewer:** So, one of the most primary definition of—kumbaga kasi depression is under clinical psychology na e, 'di ba? So, if we want to specifically talk about depression, ano siya, there's—there should be anhedonia, 'no. Anhedonia is loss of pleasure in all things. So, ibig sabihin, the things that you enjoy before, hindi mo na na-e-enjoy ngayon. Or, for example, there's very low mood, down mood, loss of interest, 'yong mga gano'n, 'no. You, kumbaga, very down 'yong overall presentation of emotion.

[58:13] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[58:15] **Interviewer:** So, if you always feel appeased, masaya naman 'yong mood mo, 'no. That's not necessarily depression, kasi 'yon 'yong primary emotion that they don't often feel, also at the time, they feel alone, lonely, 'yong mga gano'n, 'no. But there are also people who are functional depressives, gaya, for example nila, [Name], 'di ba? [Profession] pa.

[58:40] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[58:42] **Interviewer:** They seem happy when they present themselves in public, pero 'yon pala deep inside, hindi, 'no. So, kumbaga parang, it has something to do with how you're feeling inside. So, kumbaga, I think, of course there should be assessment, pero, mararamdaman niyo po 'yong sarili niyo, e. Do you often feel down in terms of mood?

[59:08] **Speaker:** Actually, ano, I don't know if I just want to settle the issue or for myself also. So, might as well, get a professional, to do that. Ayaw ko 'yong, parang, kung nag-aaway lang, saka napapag-usapan 'yon. So, minsan—minsan naiisip ko na kaya ko siguro hindi nagagawa 'yong mga nasa—kasi, minsan I don't see something wrong sa ginagawa ko, kasi parang—tapos pagdating, ano, mali pala, 'di ba. Parang...yeah 'yong—well, syempre kasi generally, my work, or as a person, I'm a problem solver, kasi.

[59:50] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[59:51] **Speaker:** So, naisip ko parang magagawan din ng paraan 'yan, ta-try natin, 'di ba? Hanggang—hanggang saan, hindi natin masasabi, pero hanggang sa kaya, mag-tatry. 'Yon lang naman.

[1:00:02] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, after our interview, I can actually refer you to some clinics if you want assessments. I think some of them still does online, kasi you seem pretty busy. So, just—if ever you're interested, I can refer you to some people. Ayan.

[1:00:23] **Speaker:** Okay, yes. Thank you, thank you.

[1:00:25] **Interviewer:** So, another question po. Do you think, for example, your relationship with your wife is good for you and in what way po?

[1:00:37] **Speaker:** Good for me. Ano kasi siya... well, syempre to—kung, walang husband, walang wife, hindi naman complete 'yong family, 'di ba? Because, we have our own responsibilities to help each other. Syempre, I cannot say na I'll be here today alone, 'di ba? Syempre, na-help din niya ako sa maraming bagay, especially with the kids, sa house, gano'n. Kasi—oh, yeah, like that. Tapos, 'yong iba mga affairs, mga kailangan asikasuhin. But ako naman, I try to do as much as I can. Even here sa house, may interactions sa house, I do the marketing, I do the grocery. Hanggang sa lahat ng, ano, nakakaya ko, gagawin—ginagawa ko naman.

[1:01:34] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:01:36] **Speaker:** 'Yong... yeah, parang gano'n.

[1:01:39] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So may nag-iba po ba sa inyo kung ikukumpara ngayon at no'ng bago pa po kayo naging in a relationship ni [Partner's Name] or bago po kayo mag-asawa?

[1:01:51] **Speaker:** Siguro 'yong... 'yong being a very outgoing person ko, 'yon 'yong isa sa pinakamalaking difference. I like to take in outdoor activities before. I—I raced professionally, off-road racing, I was the driver of—gano'n. Nag-ma-mountain bike, nag-mo-motor ako gano'n, but, ano, due to time nga, so hindi na natin masyadong ano. Parang, before I would think na riding out on my bike, mountain bike, or mag-mo-motor ako ng Sunday morning, since tulog naman lahat, babalik naman ako ng mga 9:00 or 10:00, it seems to be okay. But, no, 'yong—'yong—the fact na, gumising ako is already, ano—e, I just— yeah, I just gave it a rest na lang.

[1:02:44] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:02:45] **Speaker:** 'Di na lang muna.

[1:02:47] **Interviewer:** Kumbaga 'yong mga hobbies niyo po, 'wag muna?

[1:02:52] **Speaker:** Mhmm. Kasi parang hindi naman ano—hindi—yeah, before nagiging officer pa 'ko ng mga car clubs, mga organization, mga ano. 'Yan, we don't take part in those anymore.

[1:03:08] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:03:08] **Speaker:** Kasi nga kulang na ng oras.

[1:03:11] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, ano po, what about si [Partner's Name] po, sa tingin niyo po may nagbago sa kanya before you got married or you were together?

[1:03:25] **Speaker:** Hmm... well, for me, I think she's still ano—she—what she's before, she's still—what she does, she still does now. Gano'n naman siya, and she has, feeling ko, parang, more control naman of what she wants to do, what she doesn't wanna do at her time, gano'n.

[1:03:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:03:49] **Speaker:** For example—yeah, parang gano'n. Feel ko naman, parang, hindi naman siya masyadong na-[intelligible]--dapat, parang, generally okay pa rin siya sa—what she's doing for the past—ever since we got married, 'yong things na ginagawa niya, are still the same things naman.

[1:04:08] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, do you feel safe po in your relationship?

[1:04:14] **Speaker:** What do you mean safe?

[1:04:16] **Interviewer:** Hmm... for example, in terms of trust, safe, safety feelings. General feeling—or how would you define safety?

[1:04:29] **Speaker:** Okay... well... safe. Well, ako, I feel safe naman dahil... 'yong—when we're here—but kasi I always have this idea na kung—kung may balak, hindi mo rin mapipigilan, 'di ba? Parang—but... siguro, ano, feel ko na, ano, safe is... paano ba sabihin 'yon? Well, baka—well, I don't know, 'yong sa trust, hindi ko masyadong sure. Baka—I really do not know, 'yong—actually now hindi ko na naman alam kung—to what extent din siya—ano feeling din niya sa relationship namin, 'di ba? Baka fed up na rin siya, or whatever. So, yeah.

[1:05:29] **Interviewer:** Opo. So I'm going to show you po our rating scale. Ayan. So if we're going to rate po, in a scale of 1 to 9, my partner really listens to me, how would you rate it po?

[1:05:46] **Speaker:** Me to [Partner's Name]?

[1:05:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:05:49] **Speaker:** Ano 'yon, siguro mga 8, yeah. She really listens to me. Kasi she wants—'yon ang gusto niya.

[1:05:56] **Interviewer:** Opo. In what way does she listen to you po? How do you say na, siya nakikinig sa akin?

[1:06:05] **Speaker:** Gano'n siya, she wants—parang ano nga e, kung puwede lang lahat ng kausap ko, 'pag uwi ko ikukwento ko, verbatim lahat na napag-usapan namin. 'Yong as in lahat—as in lahat gusto niya—minsan hindi ko nga [intelligible] na, kasi 'di ba parang gist na lang, gist na lang. Tapos, 'more, I want to know more, I want to know more,' because, yeah, she wants to know.

[1:06:31] **Interviewer:** 'Yon po talaga 'yong ano, 'yong kanyang strength kumbaga, she listens to you.

[1:06:37] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[1:06:38] **Interviewer:** Ito po. 'Yong pangalawa po, my partner is responsive to my needs.

[1:06:46] **Speaker:** Siguro mga 5, kasi it's—'yong naka-establish dito sa amin is 'yong, parang, sa family namin ang priority is si [Partner's Name] and the kids, kung ano 'yong kailangan nila, ano 'yong mga priorities.

[1:07:00] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:07:02] **Speaker:** Na-mo-move lang 'yong schedule kasi dahil may kailangan ako gawin, but, other than that, 'yong—'yong, the rules, how things are, what we do, generally, especially with the kids, saka sa house, sila talaga 'yong in-a-ano na natin.

[1:07:19] **Interviewer:** Opo. Pero in terms of, 'yong sa inyo po, medyo, di masyado, would you say?

[1:07:27] **Speaker:** Well, medyo flexible naman kasi ako. Parang, okay. Kasi, parang kung kailangan, gagawin, parang gano'n.

[1:07:33] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:07:34] **Speaker:** Hindi 'yong parang, for example, 'inaantok ako, tutulog muna ako, huwag muna gagawin 'yan.' 'Pag may kailangan, go.

[1:07:40] **Interviewer:** Opo. So kumbaga parang, lagi po talaga 'yong mag-a-adjust, ano, in terms of mga gano'n. So, kumbaga in your—on your side, in terms of needs, kumbaga, you also—you're also open and acknowledge na kahit hindi 'yong needs ko muna, 'yong sa inyo muna.

[1:08:00] **Speaker:** Actually, yeah. Like—like your question earlier, like, 'yong comparing 'yong sa relation—'yong do you compare yourself with other people, 'yan, I could say na ano—'yong, I know people na 'pag sila na tutulog, 'yong parang hindi sila ginigising, 'di ba? Parang, 'natutulog 'yong dad ko, e.' Oo. Parang gano'n.

[1:08:20] **Interviewer:** 'Pag kayo po ginigising.

[1:08:21] **Speaker:** Wala—wala akong gano'n, oo.

[1:08:23] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:08:24] **Speaker:** Nagagalit nga kasi nakakatulog. But, fault ko nga, dahil I spend time sa office, but... well, okay na lang din. I tell kids, don't—don't worry. I mean, hanggang sa kaya ko—ako, if I'm really sick na, you know, I cannot physically do it anyway. I'm sorry, but up to now, if you need, early, late, o ano, game pa naman tayo diyan.

[1:08:49] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, kung okay lang din po sa inyo, we want to ask you about the physical aspects of your relationship, 'no? Pwede niyo pong sabihin sa amin if it's too sensitive for you. May we ask po, how often do you have sex?

[1:09:04] **Speaker:** Hmm... siguro now? Siguro once or twice a month.

[1:09:10] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:09:11] **Speaker:** Minsan wala pa, minsan—oo.

[1:09:13] **Interviewer:** Are you contented po with your sex life?

[1:09:17] Ako, personally, sana more.

[1:09:20] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Opo. So, is it something that you have talked about or not really?

[1:09:29] **Speaker:** Yes, we've—ah, ako dyan—ako 'yong ano dyan. I want talaga, but syempre may reasons, like, lalo na nung nagka-ano—very conscious si [Partner's Name] sa sickness and everything. So, no'ng nag-start 'yong pandemic, since I have to go out, we didn't sleep in the same room for almost two years.

[1:09:54] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:09:55] **Speaker:** Kasi gusto niya na hiwalay ako, like before, I'd just sleep sa sala lang, kasi para ma-isolate. Very ano siya—I don't know if we talked about it. 'Yong for example ngayon, balita is flu season na naman. So, parang, 'ay naku, baka 'yong kasama mo parang sinisipon,' gano'n, 'ay ano, 'yong—try to stay away first,' gano'n, gano'n. Basta pagdating sa ganyan, parang siya nagsasabi kung puwede o hindi or okay.

[1:10:27] **Interviewer:** Opo. Parang kayo po, if it's there, okay, let's go for it. But, is it something you ask or you really wait for?

[1:10:36] **Speaker:** Hindi, 'yong asking nga, she tells me that she doesn't want to be asked, kasi gusto daw niya 'yong parang spontaneous or ano—ayaw niyang pina-plan 'yong ano, so parang, hindi ko na lang din tinatanong. So, minsan hindi mo alam kung puwede o hindi, so magta-try ka na lang, ta's 'pag sabi ayaw, edi ayaw na lang.

[1:10:54] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, it depends on the mood pagdating po do'n, ano?

[1:10:58] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[1:10:59] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, next question po, ayan. This one po, how satisfied are you po in your relationship if we're going to look at this scale, ayan. Completely dissatisfied, very satisfied...

[1:11:18] **Speaker:** Siguro, somewhat satisfied.

[1:11:21] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Somewhat satisfied. So, if you're somewhat satisfied, in a scale of 1 to 10 po, how—how much will you rate your relationship?

[1:11:32] **Speaker:** Siguro mga nasa 5?

[1:11:34] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, what—may we ask po, what's the meaning of rating of 5? Ayan.

[1:11:46] **Speaker:** 'Yon nga, I've been clearly told na marami akong pagkukulang. I'm trying to catch up with... 'yon, parang, I try to improve, try to be better. Ako, I—I wish sana na... 'yong being me as a person of my interest, mayroon pa sanang space, kasi, parang, minsan sinasabi 'happy wife, happy life,' parang sobrang one-sided naman no'n.

[1:12:22] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:12:22] **Speaker:** 'Di ba? Parang, tao rin naman tayo, e, 'no? Parang, I mean, I have friends, I have—I mean, I was this person, parang, [26-30] years of my life, hindi naman sa dahil nag-asawa 'ko, parang, that—that part of me would just go away.

[1:12:41] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:12:43] **Speaker:** Before, I thought, starting up, starting from scratch—'yong gano'n, gano'n, so, medyo nababawasan 'yong mga gano'n, gano'n. But for now, parang, medyo nakakaluwag-luwag na rin naman tayo, pero gano'n pa rin, hindi pa rin—'yong issue nga, for example, 'yong as simple as, 'yong, doing something early mornings on a Sundays with—with your friends. Kasi ako, I—even my work personality, interaction e, 'yong parang—iba kasi—well—

[1:13:18] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:13:19] **Speaker:** Hindi ko na ano kay [Partner's Name] 'yong—kasi sinasabi niya, e 'di ako na lang kausapin mo palagi,' parang hindi—hindi gano'n yung point ko, kasi parang...

[1:13:25] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:13:27] **Speaker:** 'Yong, [intelligible], I—I know him, I get this because we met this. 'Yong parang, project, project, connection, connection—'yong, parang, kaibigan din, 'di ba, na come one day, 'oh, you will need, ano, kakilala,' 'oh, how do you know each other?' Like, hindi naman sa dahil sa may negosyo, kaya kayo naging [intelligible] o nag—bikemate ko 'yan, we rode motorcycle before, or you—like that—somehow, 'yong parang—some people play golf, I don't, but 'di ba? Parang the time you spent there's so—

[1:13:59] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. Yeah, yeah. Mhmm.

[1:14:00] **Speaker:** So, so much more—maghapon ka do'n. I mean, you know, some people play tennis, some people drink wine, some people play musical instruments together, kasi...

[1:14:11] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:14:13] **Speaker:** Parang, I believe 'yong support and bond mo sa ibang tao rin is—iba 'yong, parang, hindi dahil nagkakilala tayo sa work, tapos we became friends lang, kasi syempre...

[1:14:22] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:14:23] **Speaker:** Pero ako rin, parang, 'vested interest 'to, kaya ako kinakaibigan dahil may gusto sa kin,' or may—mayro'ng—'di ba? Parang—well, gano'n kasi ako. Parang...

[1:14:34] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:14:35] **Speaker:** Someday, hopefully, someday, someday.

[1:14:39] **Interviewer:** So parang, ano, kumbaga, the family life is, kumbaga, it's fine, 'di ba? It's going well, but on the other hand, parang, there are some, parang, break times for yourself na hindi niyo po nagagawa, for now, because of certain demands. 'Yon na nga po sabi ay, for example, you—you don't spend much time with the family, or something like that. So parang—

[1:15:11] **Speaker:** Saka ano rin—

[1:15:12] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:15:13] **Speaker:** Something also na, parang, you cannot—two persons are never alike. E, ako, mas outgoing ako, mas interactive ako, I mean, it—it's not my fault na you and your friends are just happy talking to each other sa phone, tapos you're just like that. E, parang ikaw ang dami mong kausap, may—may grupo ka dito, may grupo ka sa ganyan. E... well, kasi—I'm—I—I was really like that, I mean, she knew me, like, she knew me before like that, so much more pa than now, but...

[1:15:49] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:15:51] **Speaker:** Siguro, parang, keep the peace na lang din, so you make some adjustments na lang.

[1:15:54] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, parang, ano po, if we're going to label, in terms of personality type, ano? You seem to be very extroverted. Kumbaga, you like the interaction, you like the—

11608 **Speaker:** Mhmm. Yeah.

[1:16:08] **Interviewer:** Socialization. And for you, it's not about, 'just because I talk to this person, doesn't mean I like them more than you, it's just that to this kind of person, ito 'yong kaya kong—ito 'yong topic namin,' no?

[1:16:25] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[1:16:25] **Interviewer:** It's different. With person number two, we also talk about different things. So parang, in terms of stimulation, you—kumbaga, that's a need that you—well, in terms of personality, 'di ba? We want to satisfy those kinds of needs, we feel happy when we interact with people we have the same interest with, 'di ba? Kumbaga, parang, it's just a bonus in your case, because your—the nature of your job requires connection, 'di ba?

[1:16:57] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[1:16:59] **Interviewer:** Kumbaga, it's a bonus if, in the future, you'd have future projects together.

[1:17:04] **Speaker:** Yes, just like, ano, talking to high school friends, then you have your college friends, 'di ba? And then you have your business friends. Parang, the topic of that three groups will never be the same, kasi you are high school, talking about high school, and you know, but in—well, 'yon, parang gano'n. E... yeah, parang gano'n. Hindi ko, maano na, 'yong interaction na kaming dalawa 'yong—well, hindi naman sa parang—it sounds bad, but actually when I explain to her, grabe talaga 'yong nagiging reaction niya, tapos, parang, 'yong...

[1:17:40] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:17:41] **Speaker:** Hindi na-sa-satisfy, but 'di ko rin—'di ko rin may express kung...

[1:17:47] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:17:47] **Speaker:** How it should be perceived, 'di ba? Parang...

[1:17:51] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:17:52] **Speaker:** Baka mali nga, baka mali nga.

[1:17:54] **Interviewer:** Opo. Pero you know, I mean, it's also—parang I can observe kasi you—you lasted for [16-20] years—almost [16-20] years, 'di ba, and you're still together, and, parang, there's an active part, kumbaga active effort on your part as well to, you know, try to see, 'how am I going to communicate with her', 'ano ba 'yong mga issues', or 'ako ba 'yong may mali', 'di ba? It's not that you're trying to say na, 'hindi, wala 'kong mali', 'di ba? You're not being defensive, but there's a certain open mindedness in how you see even the conflicts that you're having as a couple, 'no, which is, ano, mga—it's actually a good sign, 'di ba? Kumbaga, there is an active effort, e, you know, and it's not blaming one person or another, it's more of trying to understand your situation, 'di ba? Together and as an individual, 'no? So I think, kumbaga, it's healthy that you're there, in terms of, you're not being defensive, 'walang mali sa akin'.

[1:19:04] **Speaker:** Mhmm.

[1:19:05] **Interviewer:** 'Di ba? It's just, you know, you're even asking, 'baka ako nga 'yong mali', 'di ba? There are those thoughts that I think contributes to your lasting marriage, 'di ba? For years and years together, ayan po. So, from—usually, when we try to end this interview, we tend to summarize everything, 'no, but I know how busy you are po as a person, so I don't want to take too much of your time.

[1:19:37] **Speaker:** No, I'm okay, I'm okay today. Actually, like I said, I find interest in interacting. Like, if you—you share whatever it is, like you were saying, it's because I—I like to hear it out, 'di ba? I mean, I like to hear it out, like, to know more.

[1:20:00] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:20:01] **Speaker:** Kasi, you—learner nga 'di ba? You always hear something new, you always hear something and learn something new.

[1:20:08] **Interviewer:** Opo. So, parang, is there anything po that you'd like to share about our research—with this interview, pertaining to quality of relationships? Ayan. Is there anything that you'd like to, kumbaga, for a marriage to work or for two people to work out together?

[1:20:30] **Speaker:** Well, for me, my point of view there is for a marriage to work is... the best is to have a goal. Goal, talaga. I mean, I've talked to mas matanda na—na nagtat—tinatanong niya, 'sir, okay pa kayo?'

[1:20:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:20:49] **Speaker:** Minsan, makikita mo rin may ugali 'yong asawa. May mga nag-a-advise sa kin, alam mo, minsan papasok dito, lalabas din dyan, manage, manage lang tayo. I mean, nobody's perfect, 'di ba, it's... so, nagiging clear sa 'kin 'yong goal na without me and the [1-5] kids, it's not a family—her and the [1-5] kids, it's not a family. Of age na rin 'yong kids, so they say also na... nakaka-touch nga sa kanila is to hear them na sila rin, they're willing to make adjustments and to help out, to make everything work, 'di ba? Parang gano'n. Sometimes, kapag may mga arguments, they—they help us out na kung may mali sa 'min, kung may mali talaga, sila pa nagsasabi sa 'min na, 'oh, si Papa mali this time, si Mama mali this time'.

[1:21:48] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:21:49] **Speaker:** So... kaya, ano, no reason to give up. Parang, you know...

[1:21:54] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:21:55] **Speaker:** Wala, parang everybody's there, everybody's helping out. So... kaya nga, baka-baka maaayos din.

[1:22:04] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:22:05] **Speaker:** Manage, manage, lang, 'di ba? Parang, sinasabi rin na if I get to learn more, if they get happier, ano, maybe I get something in return naman in the future. So, I look forward to that also na, parang, if I get to balance my time more, maybe I get some more me time also, or parang, kung ano man maabutan. But, ako rin, I-I like to ma-very, very big role sa akin 'yong presence ng kids, so, yeah.

[1:22:37] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:22:37] **Speaker:** Kaya dapat siguro, goal-oriented lang. I mean, some people don't care, 'di ba? Parang... I have friends who would say na 'you-whatever happens, you will always be their dad'. I mean, you leave the house now, you don't talk to them for a year, after that, you're still gonna be their dad, 'di ba, parang... ako hindi ko pa yata-hindi ko yata kaya 'yon-gawin 'yon, na mawala na knowing na-given, 'pag sila binigyan mo ng choice, ayaw rin nila mag-hiwa-hiwalay, parang gano'n.

[1:23:10] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. So, parang, that active decision, 'no, parang, keeps you going. 'Okay, let's work on our family, let's work on us as a couple, kasi our children also voice out', and you can see also, 'yon nga po sabi niyo, 'yong effort nila to help you understand each other more, which is very nice, and also shows generational difference. Kasi dati po, 'di ba po 'pag nag-a-away 'yong mag-asawa-

[1:23:39] **Speaker:** Tahimik lang.

[1:23:39] **Interviewer:** Walang say 'yong mga anak.

[1:23:41] **Speaker:** Mhmm. Actually, my-my eldest is taking a [course], because 'yon din, sabi nga niya, 'I got interested in that also, parang, maybe, I can help- pero, okay, sige. Okay, yeah. Oo.

[1:23:56] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:23:57] **Speaker:** She's going to [University] also.

[1:23:59] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:24:00] **Speaker:** So, parang gano'n, parang gano'n. Minsan sinasabi nila-

[1:24:04] **Interviewer:** So, parang [intelligible] to apply?

[1:24:06] **Speaker:** Oo. Like-like now, after her class nga, when they pick her up, she'll tell me kaagad, you know, what she's like, 'Pa, you know what, the teacher told me, twinning is bad, me and mom twinning, that's a bad-that's bad', 'yong-at least-at least, okay, okay.

[1:24:21] **Interviewer:** Opo.

[1:24:22] **Speaker:** Sometimes, she'll tell me rin na, 'Pa, sometimes I understand why you're like that, kasi, basically you grew up without—you know, without a dad, without a mom', so parang, you don't have this notion of, ano—well, ako, I admit, 'yong—parang, 'ay, wala—'yong wala ngang ano—parang, hindi nga normal, kasi 9 years old, so, parang, pag-uwi mo sa house, parang, wala na mom or dad, you know, someone's just making the decision.

[1:24:52] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:24:53] **Speaker:** Yeah, before, I—we went to, parang—parang family—'yong, counseling. 'Yan din 'yong nasasabi sa 'kin, parang, 'I think you have a very big void in you, because of your, exper'—traumatic kasi 'yong death ng dad ko, so...

[1:25:13] **Interviewer:** Mhmm.

[1:25:14] **Speaker:** Sabi niya, 'maybe it plays a big part of you', na 'yon 'yong in-ano sa 'kin—before, I was told to do some exercises, to—to let go of things more, so, yeah. I—I did try those naman.

[1:25:28] **Interviewer:** Mhmm. 'Yon nga po, 'no, parang—pero it's—kumbaga, I can somehow see na there are certain layers. For example, parang, from a surface level point of view, people can see you as, parang, a hardworking dad, 'di ba? With this, and you have difficulty, for example, sharing, or talking about your own feelings, experiences to your family, mga ganyan. Pero, parang, adding all the layers of, parang, your childhood, 'di ba? It's not just about losing your dad at a young age, at 9, 'di ba? It's about how, for example, parang, how—how he died also, you said it's traumatic, and then of course, that's just the start of another whole traumatic experience, growing up without a father figure, 'yong mga gano'n. Having to take on certain responsibilities, kasi 9... still formative, e, the years, 'di ba? So, there's definitely some significant impact on how you would have developed. Like for example, from a-

Transcript cut.